

URN PLANT

Aechmea fasciata

There are few plants as spectacular as the Aechmea in flower. The tropical foliage dusted in silver creates a vase for the “jack-in-the-box” bloom borne on a long stem. This singular flower, which lasts for up to six months, looks like a firework with its spray of pink interspersed with effervescent blue.

“I’m an air-purifying tropical sensation.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Likes a warm, bright position out of direct sunlight, ideally 70–75°F (18–25°C). Needs a temperature of at least 75°F (25°C) to flower.



POTTING

Be careful not to put it in an overly large pot since the roots might rot if they stay wet for too long. Using a free-draining orchid potting mix is best.



GROWTH RATE

From a young plant, it will take 2–3 years to reach its maximum size of 18in (45cm) tall by 24in (60cm) across.



CARE

Keep the central urn formed by the leaves filled with fresh rainwater or distilled water. Also water the compost when it feels dry.



I’ll clean your air

As a member of the bromeliad family, I am different from normal houseplants and produce oxygen during the day and remove air pollutants in the night. When combined with normal foliage plants, we create 24-hour air purification.



Let’s make babies

I demonstrate the circle of life by dying after I have flowered. But before I go, I will produce baby plants at my base to succeed me. When my top part has died fully, pull off my pups, getting as much root as possible, then pot them up.



I need special watering

Please water the center vase of my foliage, preferably with rain or distilled water. To prevent it from stagnating, replace with fresh water every month. Feed me by spraying half-strength fertilizer onto my leaves and roots every month in summer and every other month in winter.